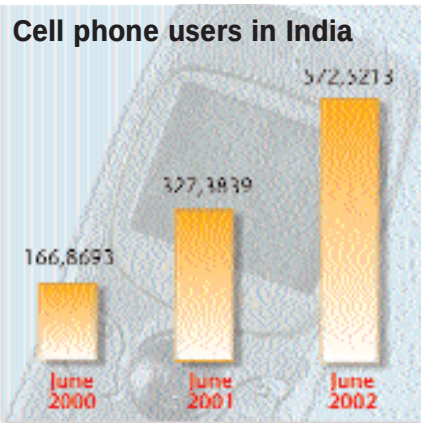




often-used functions on the phone such as message composing, the address book, etc without having to navigate though the entire menu.

Another phone that did well in this test was the Panasonic EB-GD75. It weighs just 82 grams and incorporates some really innovative features that make using the phone a snap. This phone is characterised by the tiny five-directional joystick that makes navigating through the clear and visually intuitive menu system immensely simple. This little joystick is used to control the on-screen selection box and to scroll through and select the various features and sections in the menu—all this

Battery Logic

Nickel Cadmium (NiCd): These batteries are the least expensive of rechargeable batteries available but they suffer from inherent shortcomings. For instance, the memory effect. Here, if the battery is not fully drained before you recharge it, the unused portion eventually crystallises and hence, the complete capacity of the battery is not fully utilised.

Nickel Metal Hydride (NiMH): This technology offers between 30 and 40 per cent longer operation as compared to NiCd batteries but is susceptible to loss in performance at higher temperatures. These

are also prone to the memory effect but to a significantly less extent compared to NiCd batteries.

Lithium Ion (Li-Ion): The prime advantage that these batteries have over the older NiMH batteries is that they hold more energy for the same weight and volume. Therefore, you can get the same amount of power from much smaller and thinner batteries. Also, they do not have the inherent memory effect disadvantage of NiMH batteries. The only disadvantage with these batteries is that they cost more than other types of batteries.

in a compact form factor that is just 4.1 inches long.

The Samsung SGH-A400 deserves special mention here, as it would really appeal to users who need a very small and light phone, especially female users. Based on a flip-type construction, this mobile phone collapses into a package that has almost the same length and breadth as a matchbox or a woman's makeup compact! This WAP-enabled cellular device weighs just 80 grams. However, its menu access capability is not as

simple to learn and use as that of the Nokia phones.

One phone that did not do too well in this category was the Siemens A35. Weighing in at a 'heavy' 122 grams, this phone was also much longer than the others (5.2 inches). There is no special functionality offered in terms of intuitive control of the menu system—one has to press many buttons to reach a particular function or feature. However, considering that this is also the most inexpensive phone in this roundup, it wouldn't be a bad choice if price were a major consideration for you.

The Nokia 5510, an otherwise feature-rich phone with plenty of added functionality, lost ground when it came

Samsung SGH-R220

The Samsung SGH-R220 stands out for its sturdy and neat design with a tasteful use of metallic and solid colours. The protruding antenna, however, makes the effective length of the phone greater than some other phones in its category.

With a comparatively large and high-resolution monochrome display, this phone features clear graphics when it comes to screensavers and logos. A distinctive characteristic of this phone is its deep blue backlight. However, it takes some time to get a hang of the navigation since there is no dedicated button for navigation—you have to press a combination of buttons to reach the different features in the menu. A feature that is very well implemented in this phone is the superior scheduling and calendaring options where you can set To-do lists along with reminders. Another interesting and unusual feature is the ability to change the colour of the service LED on the phone to any one of six available colours. The phone also has support for WAP.

The SGH-R220 was one of the loudest and clearest phones we tested. With very good network performance and build quality, it hits many sweet spots.

Samsung SGH-R220 **B+**

Ergonomics	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Features	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Performance	▶▶▶▶▶▶
Warranty	▶▶▶▶▶▶
OVERALL	▶▶▶▶▶▶

Price: Rs 9,000

- + Outstanding voice clarity and volume, high-resolution display, blue backlight
- Slightly bigger than some of the phones in its category

ABC 119

Ever wondered how Blue-tooth was so-named? There was a Danish Viking king, Harald Blatand (his surname means Blue tooth in English), who lived in the latter part of the 10th century. Harald Blatand united and controlled Denmark and Norway (hence the inspiration for the name: uniting devices through Bluetooth). Legend has it that old Harald had an inclination towards eating Blueberries, so much so that his teeth became stained with the colour, leaving him with a rather unique set of dentures!

Clear Options